

Make Vs. Do

Common Expressions with Make & Do

A. Make

Speaking

- make a suggestion
- make an offer
- make a complaint
- make a toast
- make a comment
- make a demand
- make an excuse
- make a point
- make a promise
- make a phone call

Cooking

- make breakfast
 - make lunch
 - make dinner
 - make a cake
 - make a sandwich
 - make coffee/tea
- *but do the cooking*

Planning

- make a decision
- make a choice
- make an appointment
- make plans
- make a date

Business

- make a deal
 - make an offer
 - make a sale
 - make a profit
 - make a fortune
 - make a payment
- *but do business*

Other

- make a mistake
- make a change
- make noise
- make war
- make an effort
- make an exception
- make time
- make sense
- make the bed

B. Do

Work & Housework

- do homework
 - do work
 - do a job
 - do chores
 - do the dishes
 - do the shopping
 - do housework
 - do the laundry
 - do the ironing
- *but make the bed*

Good & Bad

- do well
- do good
- do great
- do badly
- do one's best
- do one's worst
- do right
- do wrong
- do harm
- do damage

Activity

- do exercises / do exercise
- do push-ups
- do sit-ups
- do a crossword puzzle
- do something
- do nothing

Other

- do a favor
- do one's hair
- do one's nails
- do without
- do the cooking
- do business

Note:

Do well means to be successful at something.
Do good means to help other people.

- She did well on the test.
- That charity does a lot of good in poor countries.